



Mahmoud Adel

Application Security & Offensive Security Engineer | B.Sc. Software Engineering

Application Security · Offensive Security Engineering · B.Sc. Software Engineering
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HTB

THM

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PROFILE

Cybersecurity Engineer driven by a deep fascination with low-level systems and system architecture. Inspired to enter the field early on, I developed a passion for understanding the "core mechanics" of technology—earning the moniker Kernel. From offensive mechanics to SOC defense, I view infrastructure security as an art form built on fundamental system principles.

20+
HOF

\$1,
VERISIGN

Top 5/100
CTF

Top 0.55%
HACKTHEBOX

EXPERIENCE

Security Engineering Intern (Authorized Scope: Web/API & Network Assessment) July 2024 – September 2024

Bastion Security — Security Engineering Internship

- Assessed **8 web apps** & **2 network ranges** in authorized scope — **11 validated findings** (auth bypass, injection, privilege escalation), 6 Linux + 4 Windows root validations.
- Validated every finding to root where applicable; documented **8 reports with 0 rework** — exploitation paths and remediation notes; presented for internal review.
- Validated via manual testing plus cloud posture checks (ScoutSuite / Prowler-style) in lab environment.
- Ranked **Top 5 of 100** in internal penetration-testing and privilege-escalation challenges.

[View Credential](#) → · Bastion Security internship certificate

Software Engineer Intern

Feb 2025

National Research Tomsk State University

- Delivered **2 prototypes + 12 diagrams** (UML/SDLC) — builds system reasoning for reproducible findings.

SECURITY RECOGNITION & EVIDENCE

Hall of Fame — 20+ acknowledgments via Bugcrowd (bugcrowd.com/h/mahmoud_adel) — Named: Verisign \$1, CSRF → Account Takeover (DomainScope OAuth state, Apr 2018), DigitalOcean (Apr 2019), Pinterest & Dell (2018). **CRITICAL**

Competitive & labs: Bastion internal CTF **Top 5/100**; Hack The Box **Top 0.55% Pro Hacker** — verified badges; TryHackMe **Top 1%** — [@iamkernel](#). **VERIFIED**

Detection & research: ELK SOC Home Lab — 50k+ events, 5 Sigma MITRE-mapped, Kibana dashboards & triage workflow; IR malware triage (isolated Windows 10 VM, Sysmon/KAPE); AppArmor RCE mitigation; API security & AD attack paths. **LAB**

SECURITY RESEARCH

- Verisign CSRF → Account Takeover** — Missing OAuth state → Google-link hijack → persistent ATO + password set (\$1, reward, HoF Apr 2018). [Write-up](#) ↗
- AppArmor RCE Killswitch** — Deny /bin/** + network → audit DENIED exec /bin/sh → allowlist containment + hardening. [Write-up](#) ↗
- ELK SOC Detection Engineering** — 50k+ events, 5 Sigma MITRE-mapped rules, Kibana dashboards & triage workflow. [Write-up](#) ↗

CORE SKILLS

CORE

Web/API Security

Vulnerability Assessment

Linux

Windows

TCP/IP

Privilege Escalation (lab)

Burp Suite

Nmap

Python

Bash

APPLIED

OWASP

Network Security

Active Directory

Kerberos

Wireshark

BloodHound

Impacket

Docker

System Administration

Firewall

SIEM (ELK)

Incident Response

MITRE ATT&CK

Cloud Security (AWS IAM)

FAMILIAR

Ghidra (lab)

Metasploit (lab)

Cobalt Strike (exposure)

Sliver (lab)

Nuclei (lab)

SQLMap (lab)

ffuf (lab)

Malware Analysis (lab)

Threat Intel (exposure)

Exploit Dev (lab)

Red Team (lab)

YARA (lab)

Sigma (lab)

Suricata (lab)

Splunk (lab)

ENGINEERING

JavaScript

C/C++

Assembly

SQL

Git

Presentation

Problem Solving

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Software Engineering — Conferred Jul 2026
Tomsk State University
Sep 2022 – Jul 2026

CREDENTIALS & TRAINING

Blue Team Junior Analyst

SecurityBlue Team · 2023
[Verify](#) ↗

Cyber Threat Intelligence

IBM · 2023
[Verify badge](#) ↗

Jr Penetration Tester

TryHackMe · 2024
[Verify PDF](#) ↗

Additional: OSCP (In Progress, OffSec) · PNPT (In Progress, TCM 2025) · Linux+ (2024) · CCNA (2023)

PRACTICAL LABS & PLATFORMS

[Hack The Box](#) — [Verified Badges](#) · [Top 0.55% Pro Hacker](#)

[TryHackMe](#) — [@iamkernel](#) · [Top 1%](#)

SELECTED WRITING

[\\$1, CSRF — Verisign DomainScope ATO](#)
[AppArmor RCE Mitigation](#)
[ELK SIEM SOC Home Lab](#)

LANGUAGES

Arabic · Native
English · C2 Proficient
Russian · C1 Advanced